

# Kasey Zapatka, PhD

📍 San Francisco, CA    ✉ kaseyzapatka@berkeley.edu    🌐 www.kaseyzapatka.com    🌐 kaseyzapatka  
🔗 kaseyzapatka    🆔 0000-0002-7278-3660

## Summary

---

Social science researcher using computational and survey methods to measure policy impacts and visualize findings for stakeholders and decision-makers.

## Experience

---

### **Clean Air Task Force**, Consultant – NEPA Clean Energy Review Analysis

Remote

- Built a BERT+LLM pipeline to extract and classify records from 120,000+ NEPA documents, enabling CATF to analyze clean energy review timelines at scale
- Integrated Federal Register API data, targeted web scraping, and ML/regex classifiers to categorize 20,000+ projects by technology, review process, and capacity
- Scoped research questions collaboratively with CATF and delivered phased findings across six structured deliverables mapped to specific policy priorities
- Published findings via public [project website](#) and [HuggingFace document browser](#)

Jan 2026 – present  
5 months

### **University of California, Berkeley**, Postdoctoral Researcher and Lecturer

Berkeley, CA

- Lead cross-functional research team to develop, maintain, and analyze eviction database (150M+ records) using SQL
- Applied R-based machine learning, multilevel regression, and synthetic control methods to study impact of rental assistance on eviction filings
- Coordinated with UPenn partners, managed research process, and led report writing
- Presented findings and strategic recommendations to federal housing policy stakeholders
- Taught machine learning, natural language processing, and causal inference to PhD students
- Led 32 weekly labs in R and Python libraries (tidyverse, sklearn, TensorFlow)
- Supervised 8 student projects on predictive modeling and decision-making

July 2023 – present  
2 years 11 months

### **NYC Department of Housing Preservation & Development**, Data Scientist

New York City, NY

- Collaborated with US Census research team to establish sample survey research frame for Housing Vacancy Survey
- Addressed Housing Vacancy Survey measurement error by creating post-stratification weights
- Developed methodology with survey weights to determine where to build affordable housing, presented to non-technical stakeholders, and persuaded Commissioner to adopt methodology

Sept 2022 – June 2023  
10 months

### **City University of New York, The Graduate Center**, Research Scientist, Professor Van Tran

New York City, NY

- Built US Census dataset to study ethno-racial neighborhood integration in metro New York
- Fitted multinomial logistic regression models and interpreted marginal effects plots in R
- Wrote methodological sections, created descriptive plots in R, and managed project development on GitHub

Jan 2021 – Dec 2022  
2 years

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>City University of New York, The Graduate Center</b> , Research Scientist, Professor Paul Attewell <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Developed research projects to study divergence of benefits for groups with different educational attainment</li> <li>Managed 4 large national, longitudinal, and cross-sectional datasets used in analyses</li> <li>Used data mining, HLM, OLS, and logistic regression techniques to understand the impact of educational attainment on mid-life labor market earnings</li> </ul> | New York City, NY<br>Oct 2018 – May 2021<br>2 years 8 months  |
| <b>CUNY, Center for Urban Research</b> , UX Researcher <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Designed, executed, and led focus group research to identify key labor market trends across 10 different projects</li> <li>Distilled findings into actionable insights and presented recommendations to clients</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         | New York City, NY<br>Sept 2016 – Jan 2019<br>2 years 5 months |
| <b>Empirical Creative</b> , UX Researcher <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Designed and led mock jury trials (focus groups) to identify favorable juror characteristics and attitudes</li> <li>Conducted strategic research to understand user characteristics that shape case opinions and what facts change decisions</li> <li>Translated insights into actionable recommendations — trial strategy, user profiles, and visual graphics</li> </ul>                                                                       | New York City, NY<br>Nov 2014 – Aug 2016<br>1 year 10 months  |
| <b>Max Planck Institute</b> , Data Scientist – Superdiversity in Metro New York Project <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Managed end-to-end project development of interactive Superdiversity Website and Teaching Tool</li> <li>Built and analyzed 6 cross-sectional, longitudinal databases exploring changing diversity in Metro New York</li> <li>Supervised design team and ensured project aligned with stakeholder vision</li> </ul>                                                                                | Remote<br>Jan 2020 – Dec 2021<br>2 years                      |

## Education

|                                                                            |                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>PhD City University of New York, The Graduate Center</b> , Sociology    | New York City, NY<br>Aug 2016 – Feb 2023 |
| <b>MA Fordham University</b> , Sociology                                   | Bronx, NY<br>Aug 2014 – May 2016         |
| <b>BA Point Loma Nazarene University</b> , Spanish Literature and Language | San Diego, CA<br>Aug 2006 – May 2010     |

## selected projects

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>NEPA Clean Energy Environmental Review Analysis</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Trained BERT classifiers and LLM adjudication layer to extract review dates and process types from 120,000+ unstructured federal documents</li> <li>Integrated Federal Register API, web scraping, and ML/regex classifiers to categorize 20,000+ projects by technology, capacity, and review type</li> <li>Results: <a href="#">project website</a>, <a href="#">HuggingFace document browser</a></li> </ul> | 2026–present |
| <b>Voter Turnout in New York City</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Used Bayesian Improved Surname Geocoding (BISG) to impute race/ethnicity from surnames in 4.6 million NYC voter registration records</li> <li>Applied multilevel regression and poststratification (MrP) to impute educational attainment and build survey post-stratification weights</li> <li>Applied RAG techniques and fine-tuned open-source LLMs to extract insights from voter file records</li> </ul>                   | 2025–2026    |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |           |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>SF Residential Inspection Risk</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Jan 2025  |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Linked fire incidents, building violations, inspection records, and parcel tax data at the parcel level using APN identifiers</li> <li>• Built composite risk scores and k-means spatial clusters to prioritize inspections for SFFD and the Department of Building Inspection</li> <li>• Deployed two interactive Shiny dashboards: <a href="#">SFFD</a>, <a href="#">DBI</a></li> </ul> |           |
| <b>Superdiversity in Metro New York</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2020–2021 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Built 6 cross-sectional longitudinal databases and led end-to-end development of interactive <a href="#">website</a> and <a href="#">teaching tool</a></li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |           |
| <b>Housing Literacy</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2017–2019 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Developed <a href="#">online tool</a> annotating NYC rent regulation legal documents for rent-stabilized tenants and housing advocates</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |           |

## Publications

---

|                                                                                                                                         |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>New Frontiers of Integration: Convergent Pathways of Neighborhood Diversification in Metropolitan New York</b>                       | Feb 2023  |
| Kasey Zapatka, Van C. Tran<br><a href="#">10.7758/RSF.2023.9.1.03</a> (RSF: The Russell Sage Foundation Journal of the Social Sciences) |           |
| <b>Affordable Regulation: New York City Rent Stabilization as Housing Affordability Policy</b>                                          | Oct 2022  |
| Kasey Zapatka, Juliana de Castro Galvao<br><a href="#">10.1177/15356841221123762</a> (City & Community)                                 |           |
| <b>Superdiversity in Metropolitan New York: Technical Report</b>                                                                        | June 2021 |
| Kasey Zapatka<br><a href="#">www.superdiv-newyork.mmg.mpg.de</a> (Max Planck Institute)                                                 |           |
| <b>Reordering Occupation, Race, and Place in Metropolitan New York</b>                                                                  | Jan 2021  |
| Kasey Zapatka<br>(Springer International Publishing)                                                                                    |           |
| <b>Does Demand Lead Supply? Gentrifiers and Developers in the Sequence of Gentrification, New York City 2009–2016</b>                   | Aug 2020  |
| Kasey Zapatka<br>(Urban Studies)                                                                                                        |           |

## Skills

---

**Programming:** R, Python, SQL, Stata, Git & GitHub, Linux

**Quantitative Methods:** Spatial econometrics, Machine learning, Generalized linear regression, Natural language processing, Survey analysis, LLMs and GenAI, A/B testing

**Qualitative Methods:** Focus groups, Interviews, Stakeholder analysis, Survey design, User perception studies

**Languages:** English (native), Spanish (fluent)